Olympiad Portal: Two-Way Sign-Up System

A guide for educators, students and organisers

1. Overview

Olympiad Portal gives educators and students **two ways to register**. Both options are available on the same sign-up page:

- **With an invitation code:** an authorised user sends an email invitation. The recipient signs up using that invitation and receives approved school access immediately.
- **Without an invitation code:** anyone eligible can register normally, but must wait for an authorised person to approve their account before accessing their school area.

2. Option A: Sign Up With an Invitation Code

1. **An invitation is sent.** An organiser can invite an educator to a selected school. An approved school coordinator or educator can invite educators and students from their own school.
2. **The recipient receives an email.** The email contains a unique invitation code and a link to the sign-up page.
3. **The recipient signs up.** They follow the link and register using the *same email address* that received the invitation. The link may fill in the code automatically.
4. **The system checks the code.** It verifies the invitation, account type, school, email address and expiry.
5. **Access is granted.** A valid code activates school access immediately, without a separate manual approval step.

3. Option B: Sign Up Without an Invitation Code

1. The educator or student chooses **No invitation code** on the sign-up page.
2. They enter their details, select their school and create an account.
3. Their registration is marked **Pending Approval**. They cannot access restricted school features while waiting.
4. An authorised organiser or school coordinator reviews the request.
5. If approved, the applicant gains access to the appropriate dashboard. If rejected, school access is not granted.

4. Who Can Invite and Approve Users?

Role	Can send invitations to	Can approve registrations
Organiser	Educators at a selected school	Initial educator request when a school has no active coordinator
School coordinator	Educators and students at their school	Pending educators and students at their school
Approved educator	Educators and students at their school	No manual approval permission
Student	Nobody	No approval permission

Note: Sending an invitation does not give an ordinary educator permission to approve registrations made without a code. Those requests go to the authorised approver.

5. Which Approver Handles a Request?

- **First educator at a school:** if no active school coordinator exists, an organiser handles the initial educator request.
- **Further educators:** the school's active coordinator reviews their requests.
- **Students without codes:** the active school coordinator reviews their requests.

6. Invitation Security

- Each code can be used only once and expires after **seven days**.
- A code is linked to a specific **email address, school and account type**.
- Only authorised organisers and approved school staff may send invitations within their permitted scope.
- Invalid, expired or mismatched codes cannot grant immediate access.
- Invitation codes are stored securely as hashes.
- A student invitation does not automatically claim an existing learner's records merely because the names match.

7. School Invitations vs. Olympiad Invitations

A **school invitation** is for joining the platform and gaining access to the appropriate school account. An **Olympiad invitation** is the existing, separate process for joining or participating in a particular Olympiad. Registering with a school invitation does **not** automatically enter someone into an Olympiad.

8. Quick Examples

- **Invited educator:** an organiser emails an educator a code for Jhb High. The educator registers with that email address and gains immediate educator access.
- **Invited student:** an approved educator emails a student from their school. The student uses the code to register and gains immediate school access.
- **No code:** a student selects Jhb High during registration. The account remains pending until the school coordinator approves it.

In summary: An invitation code provides verified, immediate school access. Registration without a code remains available, but requires manual approval.